INTERNATIONAL EXPERIENCE

CH Zurich (2020–present) · GB London (2015–2020) · FR Paris (2013–2014)



Thomas Zijlstra, CFA

AI Commercialization & Enterprise AI Builder

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Work permit: EU · Switzerland

English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Financial services professional with a decade of international experience across London, Zurich, and Paris. Spent the first half of my career in investment banking—Debt Capital Markets at Société Générale in London covering DACH and Benelux financial institutions, then investment and finance work at a London family office. Since 2020, based in Zurich and focused on enterprise AI and digital transformation for regulated financial-services clients—designing and implementing agentic workflows, building AI economics frameworks, and leading programme delivery across FINMA, OeNB, and DORA-related mandates. CFA charterholder.

EXPERIENCE

> Accenture, CH Zurich

Jun 2020 – Present

Financial Services AI & Digital Transformation

- Switzerland NFR Capabilities Team Lead: built and led the local practice, connecting CEE region capabilities and defining go-to-market for non-financial risk.
- NFR practice leadership and go-to-market contribution for the DACH region within the CFO&EV division.
- Originated and led the largest Swiss insurer deal of the year — FINMA regulatory reporting and data adequacy programme (Databricks).
- Stream Lead for an OeNB central-bank audit at a European core banking provider.
- LIBOR and interest-rate-transition delivery at a European GSIB, applying capital-markets knowledge across derivatives, valuation, and trading-desk structures.
- Developed and implemented AI-agent workflows for RCSA and third-party risk management; built the AI Maturity Assessment for the NFR practice.
- Coordination across business, risk, data, technology, governance, and senior stakeholders.

• Single Family Office, GB London

Aug 2018 – Mar 2020

Investment & Finance Manager

- Company valuation and cash-flow modelling.
- Direct-investment and financing analysis.
- Debt, asset-backed, and equity-financing discussions.
- Engagement with investors, portfolio companies, and financing counterparties.
- Work in an entrepreneurial, growth-stage environment.

■ Société Générale, GB London

Jun 2015 – Jul 2018

Debt Capital Markets Analyst, FIG — DACH and Benelux (selected UK/Ireland)

- DCM origination, structuring, and execution.
- Senior, Tier 2, covered, RMBS, subordinated, and green-bond products.
- Capital-markets reporting, credit work, liquidity analysis, capacity analysis.
- Coordination with M&A, ECM, Legal, Syndication.
- Derivatives, structured products, IRS, FX options, structured notes.

- **Catalina,** FR **Paris** Jun 2013 – Jan 2014

Data Scientist (Traineeship)

— Consumer and purchasing-behaviour analysis.

— Statistical analysis of transaction data.

— Price-elasticity and product-portfolio analysis.

— Translation of analytical findings into client recommendations.

SELECTED PUBLIC PROJECTS

Enterprise NFR Agent Platform

Public technical demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/RealAIInfrastrucure

- Enterprise platform built around multiple AI agent workflows—each handling a different NFR domain—with a shared knowledge graph, document intelligence, regulatory analysis, human approval gates, and enterprise integration patterns. Built as a technical demonstrator of what a production-grade enterprise AI stack looks like in practice.
- Commercial relevance: Individual AI use cases tend to stay isolated from each other. This platform shows what it looks like when they share a knowledge graph, common agent infrastructure, and consistent approval patterns—the architecture of a platform rather than a collection of disconnected pilots.
- Note: Synthetic demonstration · no client data · not a production deployment

DORA Article 12 AI Control Line

Real client AI implementation · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/ProReinsuranceAIWorkflow

- A working AI workflow built as a client deliverable, not a demo. Takes a live regulatory requirement (DORA Article 12) through AI-generated control updates, infrastructure proposals, policy-engine verification, compliance documentation, human approval gates, and produces a complete traceable evidence chain.
- Commercial relevance: This is what implemented enterprise AI looks like in practice: real model integration (OpenAI o3 for regulatory reasoning, GPT-4o for infrastructure, GPT-4o-mini for documentation), an 11-state machine for end-to-end traceability, and human approval gates embedded at every consequential step.
- Note: Published with anonymized client context · integration patterns reflect real enterprise architecture

Enterprise AI Economics Simulator

Public executive decision tool · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/AICostSimulator

- Interactive tool for modelling the full economics of an enterprise AI platform—model selection and routing, token costs, cloud vs. sovereign vs. on-premise hosting, shared infrastructure costs, governance overhead, and net value projections. Built for executive decision-making and proposal development.
- Commercial relevance: Most AI business cases focus on capability without modelling what it actually costs to run at scale. This tool lets a buyer or solution architect work through the complete picture, including what shared infrastructure and governance overhead do to unit economics.
- Note: All prices, benchmarks, gains, and allocation values are illustrative planning assumptions.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

CFA Charterholder

CFA Institute

MSc Finance and Investments

2014 – 2015

Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University

Cum laude · 8.5/10

Thesis: "Credit rating changes and their effect on asymmetric information"

BSc International Business Administration

2011 – 2014

Rotterdam School of Management

Honours · 8.1/10

CAPABILITIES

Commercial & Strategic

AI commercialization · opportunity qualification · customer discovery · buyer/stakeholder mapping · executive communication · financial modelling · AI economics · proposal development · paid-pilot design · program delivery · commercial hypothesis testing · expansion-playbook design

AI & Architecture

agentic workflows · LangGraph · LangChain · human-in-the-loop · knowledge graphs · document intelligence · model-provider abstraction · evaluation design · AI governance · model-routing and cost models

Engineering & Integration

Python · FastAPI · REST APIs · ServiceNow integration patterns · MCP · NetworkX · SQLite · TypeScript · JavaScript · React · Next.js · HTML/CSS · workflow state machines

Financial Services

Non-Financial Risk · RCSA · TPRM · DORA · AI risk management · regulatory reporting · data adequacy · LIBOR transition · capital markets · FIG · derivatives/valuation concepts

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)